

Multiplication

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Introduction

Remember the long multiplication from grade school? Computers do basically the same thing, just translated to binary math and optimised for digital computing.

Learning Objectives

In this laboratory you learn, how binary multiplication is implemented. You will implement the algorithm in assembly.

Principle of Long Multiplication

For binary Multiplication it is important to know the number of digits of the result. This is especially true, when multiplying negative numbers, which are represented in two's complement.

The length of the output of a multiplication can be determined by adding the lengths of the inputs. This holds true regardless of the calculations radix and can be tested quite easily. In a decimal system for example the highest number with two digits is 99. The maximum product of two digit numbers is therefore $99 * 99 = 9801$. We can repeat this experiment for a two and three digit number: $99 * 999 = 98'901$.

But what is multiplication? Let us take a look at the following example: $3 * 12$. It means that we add twelve three times. This is already a method to implement multiplication.

This method is not very practical for bigger numbers as the number of algorithm iterations (order) depends on the value of the multiplier. The order of long multiplication only depends on the number of digits of the multiplier, which scales a lot slower and can be implemented in hardware for single cycle multiplication.

Here is an example for $23 * 74$:

1	23 * 74
2	-----
3	222
4	148
5	----
6	1702
7	====

The same multiplication with binary numbers:

1	10111 * 1001010
2	-----
3	1001010
4	1001010
5	1001010
6	0000000
7	1001010
8	-----
9	11010100110
10	=====

This is much simpler in the binary system, as there are only the digits 0 and 1, i.e. the multiplicand only needs to be added if the corresponding digit of the multiplier is 1, otherwise the addition can be omitted.

Project Frame

You shall implement algorithms for multiplying **unsigned 16 bit** values, **signed 16 bit** values and **unsigned 32 bit** values. The provided program contains a file for each implementation, which also provides a unit test for your function. The test reads testvalues from a table and compares the calculated result against a reference value. If all tests pass the 7 segment display will show **PASS**, otherwise it will show **FAIL**.

The desired operation can be chosen with the buttons **T0..T2**. The LCD displays the operation executed last, the LEDs show which test values failed.

Overview of Input and Output

Task 1 Unsigned 16 bit multiplication

Implement a function to multiply to unsigned 16 bit operands. The operands are passed in register **r0** and **r1**. The result shall be return in register **r0**.

- 1) Take a look at the unit test. What does it do?

- 2) Run the program. Since the multiplication is not implemented yet, the 7 segment display will show **FAIL** and the LEDs will indicate the failed calculations.
- 3) Insert a **mul**s instruction in the function **operation** and confirm, that the test passes. The LEDs should remain dark.
- 4) Now implement the multiplication yourself. Test your implementation and ensure it passes the test.

At this point you should know, how to call functions in assembly, in case the lectures have not yet covered this topic, here is an example:

```
bl <function_name>
```

Task 2 Signed 16 bit multiplication

For this task you shall implement a function to multiply two signed 16 bit numbers. You can copy your implementation from [Task 1](#) and modify it to work with signed numbers. Insert your code at the marked location in **mul_s16.s** and test your program.

- The sign extension of the input values can be achieved with the instruction **SXTH**.
- The signed multiplication requires 32 loop iterations.

Task 3 Unsigned 32 bit multiplication

Now implement the multiplication of unsigned 32 bit values. Insert your code in the function **operation** in **mul_u32.s**. Test your code and ensure it passes the test.

Grading

Criteria	Weight
The program meets the requirements of Task 1 .	2/4
The program meets the requirements of Task 2 .	1/4
The program meets the requirements of Task 3 .	1/4